

Data Scope and Rule Applicability Policy for Automated Assessment

Which controls may be evaluated at payment-screening stage, and how to report a control that is out of scope

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Modelled on public sources	Internal control design convention for staged automated assessment, aligned to the risk-based approach
Classification	SYNTHETIC - HACKATHON TRAINING DATA

This document is synthetic content authored for a multi-agent fraud intelligence hackathon. It paraphrases the structure and themes of public materials (Internal control design convention for staged automated assessment, aligned to the risk-based approach) but contains no verbatim reproduction of them. Thresholds, codes and identifiers are illustrative.

1. Why this policy exists

An automated assessment performed at payment-screening stage receives only the payment message and the counterparty account records. It does not receive the customer file, the onboarding questionnaire, or the trade documentation. Applying a documentation-based control at that stage produces a finding of missing evidence on every single payment, which carries no analytical signal and floods the reviewer with noise.

This policy therefore establishes that a control is assessed only where its required inputs belong to the data tier available to the assessing agent. A control outside that tier is reported as OUT_OF_SCOPE_AT_THIS_STAGE. It is not a deficiency, it is not insufficient data, and it never drives the overall outcome.

2. Data tiers

Tier	Content	Available at payment screening
Tier A - payment and account data	Origin and destination institution and country, account identifiers, account age and status, amount, currency, value date, transaction type, prior alert or case history on the accounts	Yes - always

Tier	Content	Available at payment screening
Tier B - relationship data	Customer risk band, declared activity and expected geography, behavioural baseline, related party links	Only where the customer master is joined to the assessment
Tier C - documentary evidence	Identity documents, beneficial ownership records, purpose declarations, source of funds and wealth evidence, invoices, customs declarations, contracts	No - held in the onboarding and case management systems

The assessing agent shall declare, at the head of every assessment, which tiers were available to it. A reviewer can then read a clean set of findings without having to infer why documentary controls were not discussed.

3. Outcome vocabulary

Outcome	Meaning	Effect on the overall result
TRIGGERED	The rule condition is met on the available data	Contributes to the risk score
NOT_TRIGGERED	The rule was evaluated and its condition is not met	Contributes as a negative signal
OUT_OF_SCOPE_AT_THIS_STAGE	The rule requires a data tier not available to this agent	No effect; listed once in an appendix, never in the findings body
INSUFFICIENT_DATA	The rule inputs are within the available tier but a specific field is null or malformed on this record	No effect on score; raises a data quality observation naming the field

INSUFFICIENT_DATA is reserved for genuine data quality problems inside the available tier, for example a missing country code on a Tier A record. It shall not be used for documentation the agent was never expected to receive. Misuse of this outcome is the single most common defect in automated assessment output, because it converts a design decision about scope into an apparent control failure.

4. Reporting convention

- The findings body contains only TRIGGERED and NOT_TRIGGERED results. Nothing else appears there.
- Out of scope controls are summarised as one line stating how many controls require Tier B or Tier C data, with their identifiers listed in an appendix. They are not enumerated individually with an explanation of what is missing.
- The overall outcome shall never be driven by absent documentation. A payment with no triggered rule and a low corridor rating is reported as NO ADVERSE PAYMENT-LEVEL INDICATORS, not as review required.

- Where escalation is warranted, the agent names the specific documentary evidence a human reviewer should request. This is expressed as a next action, never as a finding of non-compliance.
- An assessment that returns the same outcome for every transaction has no discriminating power and shall be treated as a control design defect, not as a conservative result.

5. Escalation ladder for payment-stage assessment

Payment-level evidence	Outcome	Next action
No rule triggered, corridor LOW or MEDIUM	NO ADVERSE PAYMENT-LEVEL INDICATORS	Release; log the assessment
No rule triggered, corridor HIGH	PROCEED WITH CORRIDOR NOTE	Release; record the corridor rating and the local documents consulted
One rule triggered	MONITOR	Release; add both accounts to the watch set for 30 days
Two or more rules triggered, or one rule with a HIGH corridor	ENHANCED REVIEW	Hold; request the specific Tier B or Tier C evidence named by the triggered rules
Prior confirmed laundering involvement on either leg plus any triggered rule	ESCALATE	Hold; open a case and cite the local documents for both legs
Prohibited corridor or sanctions nexus	BLOCK	Block and escalate within 4 hours

The distinction between the first two rows and ENHANCED REVIEW is what makes the output useful. An assessment that cannot separate a clean payment from an undocumented one has not performed a risk assessment; it has only restated the limits of its own input.